# ENG517 SHORT HANDOUTS MIDTERM

## Lesson 06,07

## (ENG517) Computer Assisted Language Learning

**EFFORT BY VUHELPERS24 TEAM**

**REGARDS : SIR ZAHID: 03342743020**

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## Lecture- 6

# CALL Evaluation

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**Module 13: Principles of CALL Evaluation**

**Topic 26 - Principles for CALL Evaluation**

**Why has CALL been viewed as an experiment requiring scrutiny beyond other classroom activities?**

CALL has been viewed as an experiment due to its need for continuous evaluation and justification, even when the results remain inconclusive.

**What three needs must be addressed to improve CALL evaluation?**

The three needs for improving CALL evaluation are:

1. Incorporating findings and theory-based speculation about ideal conditions for SLA.

2. Providing guidance on how evaluation criteria should be used.
3. Applying criteria and theory to both software and the tasks teachers plan.

**What are the five principles of evaluation for CALL discussed in the text?**

The five principles are:

1. Evaluation of CALL is a situation-specific argument.
2. CALL should be evaluated through two perspectives: judgmental analysis of software and planned tasks, and empirical analysis of learners' performance.
3. Criteria for CALL task quality should come from theory and research on instructed SLA.
4. Criteria should be applied in view of the purpose of the task.
5. Language learning potential should be the central criterion in the evaluation of CALL.

**Topic 27 - Criteria from Theory and Research on SLA**

**What is the concept of "language learning potential" in the context of CALL evaluation?**

Language learning potential refers to the extent to which a CALL activity promotes beneficial focus on form and encourages language learning, rather than just language use.

**How does "learner fit" relate to CALL evaluation criteria?**

"Learner fit" considers whether the difficulty level of the targeted linguistic forms is appropriate for the learners and whether the task suits the characteristics of the intended learners.

**What does "authenticity" mean in the context of CALL evaluation?**

"Authenticity" refers to the degree of correspondence between a CALL task and real-world language tasks that learners may encounter outside the classroom.

**Why is "positive impact" an important criterion in CALL evaluation?**

"Positive impact" assesses the effects of a CALL task beyond language learning potential, including its effects on learners, teachers, and the educational system as a whole.

**What does "practicality" refer to in CALL evaluation?**

"Practicality" evaluates how easy it is for learners and teachers to implement a CALL task within the constraints of their class or language program, including hardware, software, and personnel resources.

**Module 14: Judgmental Evaluation of CALL**

**Topic 28 - Judgmental Evaluation of CALL**

**What are the two main aspects that judgmental evaluation criteria for CALL focus on?**

Judgmental evaluation criteria for CALL focus on both the aspects of the task designed by the software and those designed by the teacher.

**What is a key advantage of computer-assisted classroom discussion in CALL?**

Computer-assisted classroom discussion increases participation from all members of the class and allows for more interaction and engagement.

**In a micro-world activity, how do learners interact with the computer?**

In a micro-world activity, learners interact with the computer through oral conversation to determine what, when, and how they will input words into the game, usually as part of a guessing game.

**What is the main focus of a text analysis CALL activity?**

The main focus of a text analysis CALL activity is on grammatical form and the use of a grammar checker to revise written work.

**What does the term "storyboard" refer to in CALL?**

A storyboard in CALL refers to a guessing game activity where learners work collaboratively through oral conversation to input words and complete a task with limited textual information.

**Module 14** "**Empirical Evaluation of CALL"**

## Topic 29: Empirical Evaluation of CALL; Evidence for CALL Qualities; Language Learning Potential; Focus on Form; Modified interaction; Modified output

### What is empirical evaluation, and why is it important in CALL?

Empirical evaluation is a systematic method for testing hypotheses about the benefits of CALL tasks. It's essential because it provides empirical data to support or refute the claims about CALL qualities and their impact on language learning.

### What are the qualities that need to be evaluated in CALL tasks, and why?

The qualities to be evaluated in CALL tasks include language learning potential, learner fit, meaning focus, authenticity, impact, and practicality. Evaluating these qualities helps understand the effectiveness of CALL tasks in promoting language learning.

### How can evidence for the language learning potential of a CALL activity be demonstrated?

Evidence for language learning potential can be demonstrated by showing that learners have improved in their control of the target language aspects focused on in the activity and that they focused on the form during the CALL task.

### Why is "focus on form" important in CALL, and what evidence supports its effectiveness?

"Focus on form" is important because it draws learners' attention to specific linguistic forms. Research suggests that CALL materials with carefully selected and highlighted target forms can offer superior language learning potential.

### What is meant by "modified interaction" in CALL, and how can it benefit language learning?

Modified interaction in CALL refers to interruptions in the meaning-making process due to comprehension or production breakdowns. Research indicates that such interruptions, when built into CALL materials, can enhance language learning.

**How can CALL tasks encourage learners to modify their output, and what evidence supports the value of modified output?**

CALL tasks can encourage learners to modify their output by providing feedback and opportunities for correction. Studies have shown that pinpointing learners' errors and offering intelligent feedback can lead to better language learning outcomes.

**What are some research methods used to demonstrate the language learning potential of CALL activities?**

Research methods include pretests and post-tests to assess learners' knowledge before and after using CALL, comparing groups using and not using CALL, and assessing retention of what was learned over time.

**How can evidence for modified interaction in CALL be collected and what does it reveal?**

Evidence for modified interaction in CALL can be collected by observing learners' requests for modified input, such as repetitions or definitions. This reveals the extent to which learners engage in interactional modifications and how useful the CALL task is for potential acquisition.

**What is the challenge in research related to conditions in CALL, and how can it be addressed?**

The challenge is to demonstrate whether learners' engagement in conditions is related to acquisition. This can be addressed by assessing whether the use of interactional modifications in CALL tasks increases acquisition of the forms for which they are used.

**Learner Fit**

**How can teachers assess learner fit for learning materials?**

Teachers can assess learner fit through systematic research methods, including observation, assessment of learning outcomes, and questioning learners about their opinions.

**What can systematic analysis reveal about learner fit?**

Systematic analysis can reveal the extent to which a CALL task engages learners at an appropriate level of difficulty and is suitable for their individual characteristics.

**Level of Linguistic Difficulty**

**What is the empirical question about linguistic difficulty?**

The empirical question is about the evidence suggesting that the targeted linguistic forms are at an appropriate level of difficulty for learners.

**How can linguistic difficulty be assessed using process data?**

Linguistic difficulty can be assessed by examining process data, such as interactional modifications and the use of help options by learners.

**Individual Characteristics**

**How can a task's appropriateness to individual characteristics be assessed?**

Assessing a task's appropriateness to individual characteristics can be done by examining outcomes and learning processes, such as cognitive style and task variables.

**What did Abraham's study reveal about field-independent and field-dependent learners?**

Abraham's study found that field-independent learners performed better with a rule presentation approach, while field-dependent learners performed better with software presenting examples of the structure.

**Meaning Focus**

**How is meaning focus empirically determined in CALL tasks?**

Meaning focus is determined through observation of learners' interactions and language in CALL tasks and their reports of where their attention is directed during the task.

**Effects of Meaning-based Instruction**

**What do studies suggest about the role of meaning in language learning?**

Studies suggest that tasks requiring learners to comprehend message meaning are superior to tasks focused solely on structural manipulation.

**How was the hypothesis regarding meaning tested in Robinson's study?**

The hypothesis about meaning was tested by providing an experimental group with a contextualized grammar task and a control group with a task containing semantically unrelated items.

**Assessing Engagement with Meaning**

**What is the evidence for learners' engagement with meaning in CMC tasks?**

Evidence for engagement with meaning can be observed through learners' interactions and language in CALL tasks and their reports of their attention during the task.

**Authenticity**

**How can the authenticity of CALL tasks be assessed?**

Authenticity can be assessed by comparing learners' performance in CALL tasks to what is expected outside the CALL task.

**What does Chun's study suggest about the benefits of CACD for learners?**

Chun's study suggests that CACD enhances various linguistic skills and could transfer competence to spoken conversation.

**Module 16 - Research Methods in CALL (Topic No: 30)**

**Research Methods**

**What are some systematic research methods used to assess CALL task authenticity?**

Researchers use discourse analysis to examine CALL task authenticity, looking at language input, output, and interaction.

**What are the five descriptive categories used to analyze L2 input, output, and interaction for CALL task authenticity?**

The five categories are pragmatic function, linguistic characteristics, quantity, non-linguistic moves and forms, and medium.

**Positive Impact**

**How do CALL enthusiasts describe the impact of CALL activities on language classrooms?**

CALL enthusiasts often describe the impact as positive, emphasizing changes in classroom dynamics and improved language learning experiences.

**What kind of questions should be asked to assess the impact of CALL activities on learners and teachers?**

Questions can include, "What evidence suggests that learners learn more about the target language?" and "What evidence suggests that instructors engage in sound second language pedagogical practices by using the task?"

**What is the term used to describe the unequal access to modern ways of life, including digital literacy?**

This is referred to as the "digital divide."

**Practicality**

**What is the practicality of CALL dependent on?**

The practicality of CALL relies on the sufficiency of hardware, software, and personnel resources.

**How do resources for CALL extend beyond traditional language laboratories?**

Resources for CALL now extend to various digital platforms and tools beyond traditional language laboratories, making the assessment of resource adequacy more complex.

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# Lecture- 7

## Theoretical and Pedagogical Concerns inCALL

**Module: 17 - TEORETICAL AND PEDAGOGICAL CONCERNS IN CALL- I**

**Topic No: 31 - 32**

**Concerns for Software Development:**

**What is the strength and weakness of some computer-based materials regarding scope and sequence?**

Some computer-based materials lack a clearly determined scope and sequence, allowing individual learners to choose their learning path, which can be both a strength and a weakness.

**What is the disorientation problem in hypertext materials, and why is it a concern?**

The disorientation problem arises in hypertext materials because learners have more degrees of freedom to navigate, making it easier to get lost or disoriented in a vast network of information.

**What are affordances and misaffordances in CALL, and why should they be considered?**

Affordances should be clear to learners, indicating what a program can offer, while misaffordances distract the learner. Clear affordances minimize distractions.

**How can software be made more responsive to learners?**

Better software can use timed prompts to guide learners and encourage them to access available resources.

**How can a good interface in collaborative situations encourage learner interaction?**

A good interface should prompt learners to share control and engage in dialogue, fostering collaborative interactions.

**What is the role of questions and prompts in learner-centered software development?**

Questions and prompts can make software more learner-centered and help guide learners into good collaborative learning practices.

**What is the main reason for mismatches in program implementation, according to Nunan?**

Mismatches often occur because program planners and teachers have different expectations from learners.

**How can the use of questions and prompts enhance learner-centeredness?**

Questions and prompts can make software more learner-centered and help guide learners into good collaborative learning practices.

**Pedagogical Concerns for Classroom Practice:**

**How do most teachers view the role of computers in the classroom today?**

Most teachers see computers as complementary tools rather than alternatives to traditional teaching methods.

**What potential false notions can learners develop through limited metaphors of computer interaction?**

Learners may develop false ideas about what computers are, how information systems work, and other forms of interaction due to limited metaphors.

**What teaching functions are now assumed by software learning packages?**

Software learning packages assume functions like presenting learning activities, checking students' understanding, and providing opportunities for practice, among others.

**What limitations are there to software taking the place of a teacher, according to Richards?**

While software can assume some teaching functions, there are clear limits to how it can replace a teacher, and teachers still play a crucial role in effective language teaching.

**Software Objectives:**

**What is the key issue regarding the use of behaviorist or constructivist interfaces in collaboration at the computer?**

The key issue is whether behaviorist or constructivist interfaces facilitate collaboration and SLA effectively, which remains unresolved.

**How can teachers explain the skills that software packages aim to improve?**

Teachers can brainstorm with learners to identify the language skills they need and use this information to select appropriate CALL software.

**How can a schema of learners' needs and software categories help promote learner-centeredness?**

Creating a schema helps learners organize their learning and become more responsible for their learning, increasing intrinsic motivation.

**Making Better Use of Existing Materials:**

**How can learners benefit when a CALL program does not meet their needs?**

Learners can benefit through reflection on their learning materials and strategies and by considering how to adapt the program.

**How can learners adapt a CALL program when it's not suitable?**

Learners can create user manuals with a set of questions or add layers of tasks to make the program more suitable.

**Establishing an Environment for CALL:**

**What kind of environment is necessary for successful collaboration at the computer?**

An environment that matches the social and interactive nature of CALL activities is necessary for successful collaboration.

**How does individual laptop ownership and wireless networks impact learning environments?**

They make learning environments more flexible and supportive of collaborative learning.

**What challenges to collaboration can traditional school environments present?**

Traditional school environments, with isolated computer setups and restricted access, can discourage collaborative learning.

**Module 18: Theoretical and Pedagogical Concerns in CALL - II**

**Topic 33: Evaluating Software**

**Why is it important for teachers to be aware of the model of instruction in CALL software?**

Knowing the model of instruction helps moderate expectations for software organization and tasks.

**How can teachers classify CALL software for evaluation purposes?**

Teachers can classify software through professional reviews and in-house reviews.

**What is the significance of having teacher-created in-house software reviews in a classroom?**

In-house reviews help learners engage in critical thinking about the learning materials they use.

**Topic 34: Learning and Working Styles**

**Why is defining learners' learning styles challenging?**

Defining learning styles can be difficult, time-consuming, and non-transferable across disciplines.

**What should learners consider about their preferred learning style?**

Learners should consider whether their current learning style is efficient and if it needs improvement.

**What role should teachers play in fostering better habits, collaborative strategies, and interpersonal relationships in a computer-based learning environment?**

Teachers should be aware of their roles in fostering these aspects.

**Evolving Technology**

**What challenges are associated with evolving technology in CALL?**

Challenges include the cost of maintaining the latest technology, lack of funds, lack of expertise, and lack of suitable authoring programs.

**How has the cost of creating multimedia materials changed over the years?**

The cost of producing multimedia materials has reduced due to more powerful computers and affordable authoring tools.

**Commercial Software**

**Who often makes critical decisions about the creation of popular educational software?**

Software programmers, engineers, and marketing executives, rather than educators, make many critical decisions.

**Why does A. Bailin emphasize the importance of teachers being involved in creating language-learning software?**

To ensure that software suits the needs of the local culture and educational context.

**Making Better Use of Existing Materials**

**Why is it important for learners to determine their expertise and motivation when using CALL?**

Determining expertise and motivation enhances the quality of collaboration and learning.

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**What challenge does CALL face in creating materials that encourage learners to shape their roles and working process?**

The challenge is to create materials that encourage learners to make decisions about what to do and how to do it.

**Why is determining goals and priorities a concern in CALL with computer-based multimedia?**

Learners need to balance task completion with exploration due to the non-linear nature of many CALL materials.

**How do perceptions of technology influence collaboration at the computer in CALL?**

Learners' perceptions of technology can affect their willingness to explore, problem-solve, and engage in negotiation of meaning with both the computer and other learners.

**Module 19: TEORETICAL AND PEDAGOGICAL CONCERNS IN CALL- III**

**Topic 35: Copyright and plagiarism; Viruses; Safety online; Technological have-nots**

**8.8 Copyright and Plagiarism:**

**What does "digital" mean in the context of computer-based information?**

"Digital" means that computer-based information can be broken down into binary numbers (ones and zeros).

**In some countries, under what provision within copyright law can learners use materials for in-class projects?**

In some countries, there's a fair use provision within copyright law that allows learners to use some materials for in-class projects.

**Can learners repost images and text borrowed from the internet onto the WWW?**

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No, learners do not have the right to repost images and text borrowed from the internet onto the WWW.

**What is plagiarism, and how can teachers check for it?**

Plagiarism is using someone else's work without proper attribution. Teachers can check for plagiarism by using search engines or tools like Turnitin.

**8.9 Viruses:**

**How are viruses distributed through the WWW and email?**

Viruses are distributed through the WWW and email.

**What can viruses do to a computer?**

Viruses can destroy files, slow down a computer's performance, or even destroy data.

**How do viruses spread once they enter a computer?**

Once a virus enters a computer, it can spread by taking advantage of the email address list, sending itself to everyone on the list.

**8.9.1 Thought Viruses:**

**What are "thought viruses" on the internet?**

"Thought viruses" refer to misinformation and erroneous information that spreads from one person to another through email messages and online content.

**How can misinformation on the internet lead to cultural misunderstandings?**

Misinformation on the internet can lead to cultural misunderstandings, where people may believe false stories that denigrate other cultures.

**8.10 Safety Online:**

**What is one potential danger of unmoderated chat lines for learners?**

Learners on unmoderated chat lines may encounter individuals posing as someone they are not, including pedophiles or individuals asking inappropriate questions.

**What are some of the "kids' rules for online safety"?**

Some of the rules include not giving out personal information, informing parents about uncomfortable information, and not agreeing to meet someone from online without parental consent.

**8.10.1 Censorship:**

**How have governments used censorship to control content on the WWW?**

Governments have used censorship by shutting down Internet Service Providers (ISPs) carrying negative content or content they dislike.

**What are some limitations of using net nanny programs for content control?**

Net nanny programs can sometimes block informative sites or over-filter content, such as blocking words like "sex" or "Nazis."

**8.10.2 Cyberbullying:**

**What is cyberbullying, and why is it concerning for students?**

Cyberbullying is online harassment, including threatening emails and social media posts. It's concerning for students because it can lead to emotional distress.

**What did Li's research find about the prevalence of cyberbullying?**

Li's research found that about a quarter of the students in their study had been victims of cyberbullying.

**8.11 Technological Have-Nots:**

**What is the "international digital divide"?**

The international digital divide refers to the disparity between technology-rich and technology-poor nations, particularly in terms of internet access.

**What are some challenges facing CALL (Computer-Assisted Language Learning) related to technology?**

Challenges facing CALL include access to computers, the need for proper software, training, and maintenance, and addressing issues students face on the internet.

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